

August 2026

Dear Christopher,

I've worked in Moraga long enough to know that a well-positioned home on a quiet cul-de-sac with mature fruit trees and a finished two-car garage doesn't come along every season, and 206 Sheila Ct caught my attention the moment it hit the market. The combination of a thoughtfully updated interior, a generous 10,450-square-foot lot, and that proximity to the trail network is exactly what a certain kind of Lamorinda buyer has been waiting for. When the listing came off the market after 21 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out, because I don't think the home is the issue.

Twenty-one days is short enough that it might feel like bad luck, but in my experience it usually points to something more specific. At \$885 per square foot, this home is priced at the upper end of the Moraga range, and that number is supportable given the condition and the lot. The problem is that supporting a number like that requires marketing that builds the case for it, visually and narratively, before a buyer ever schedules a showing. A description that reads as a competent list of features is not the same thing as a story that makes a qualified buyer feel certain they're looking at the right home. I think the listing had the first, but not the second.

I've put together a short packet that walks through three specific areas where the strategy fell short and what a relaunch would look like if we addressed each of them directly. It's not a pitch to re-list at a lower number. It's an honest look at the gap between what this home is worth and how it was positioned.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to disregard this entirely. If you're not, I'd welcome a brief call to walk through what I've found.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

206 Sheila Ct

Moraga, CA 94556

4.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 1,909 Sq Ft · Moraga

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 206 Sheila Ct

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Refined Cul-de-Sac Home with Genuine Premium Assets - and a Listing That Left the Case Unmade

206 Sheila Ct has the fundamentals that Lamorinda buyers at this price point are actively looking for: a flexible four-bedroom floor plan with a main-level guest suite, an updated kitchen with double ovens and stone counters, a finished two-car garage with sealed flooring and built-in storage, and a 10,450-square-foot lot with a private backyard framed by mature fruit trees. The home sits near top-rated schools and direct trail access, which are two of the most consistent buyer motivators in the Moraga market. These are real, defensible assets.

The listing history doesn't reflect those assets. At \$885 per square foot, this home is priced at the upper tier of the Moraga market, which is justified by its condition and lot size, but that justification has to be built explicitly in the marketing. The listing spent 21 days active without converting, which suggests the strategy reached buyers but didn't persuade them. The description catalogued the home's features without giving buyers the visual depth or narrative confidence to act at that price. A standard MLS approach doesn't close that gap.

\$1,690,000

List Price

\$885/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to do one specific thing: give qualified buyers at the \$1.69M level the visual evidence and the narrative to justify the premium before they arrive at the front door. The home earns the number. The strategy has to prove it.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: Premium Priced at \$885/sqft, but the Marketing Never Justified the Number

At \$885 per square foot, 206 Sheila Ct sits above the top of the standard updated Moraga range, which runs to roughly \$820 per square foot. That's not a flaw - the finished garage, updated kitchen, double ovens, stone counters, and 10,450-square-foot lot are all real differentiators that support a premium. But buyers comparing this home against others in the \$1.6M to \$1.7M range need to understand specifically what they're getting at that number that they can't find down the street. The listing described the features. It never built the argument. When buyers can't answer their own 'why is this worth more' question, they don't make offers - they keep looking.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses Zillow Showcase placement to tell a structured premium story directly on the portal page where buyers are already comparing - not buried in remarks, but in the framing buyers see first.

Friction #2: The Visual Story of This Lot Was Never Told

A 10,450-square-foot cul-de-sac lot with a private backyard, brick patio, separate side yard, and mature fruit trees is not a standard Moraga offering. It's a specific kind of space that photographs poorly with ground-level MLS angles and satellite thumbnails. Buyers scrolling listings at this price range don't register 'grassy lawn and fruit trees' from a flat wide-angle - they need to see the lot in context: the setting, the privacy, the scale, the street position. Without that, the outdoor space reads as a line item rather than the premium it actually represents. A buyer who might have stretched to \$1.69M for a yard like this probably kept scrolling.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour captures the lot position, street setting, and private backyard in a way ground photography simply cannot - giving buyers the spatial context to understand what they're actually getting before they ever schedule a showing.

Friction #3: The Right Buyers Were Never Actively Found

At \$1,690,000, the buyer pool is real but narrow. These are typically move-up buyers from Oakland or San Francisco, or Lamorinda families relocating within the market, who are doing serious online research before they commit to a showing. In that environment, passive MLS distribution is not enough. The buyers who remain active at this price point are selective and well-informed, and they need to encounter this home in the right context - not just on a standard listing feed, but in targeted placements that reach them while they're actively thinking about Moraga. This listing was available to those buyers, but it wasn't built to find them.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork runs geo-targeted digital campaigns that put this home directly in front of SF and East Bay buyers who are already researching Lamorinda - reaching the decision-maker before they've settled on another property.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	206 Sheila Ct	Moraga Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$885/sqft	Premium tier: \$750–\$820/sqft
Lot / Setting	10,450 sqft cul-de-sac lot with private backyard and side yard	Typical Moraga lot: 6,000–9,000 sqft
Architectural Character	1967 two-story, open layout, fireplace, custom built-ins	Similar vintage single-family inventory throughout Moraga
Premium Features	Double ovens, stone counters, finished garage with sealed flooring, main-level bedroom/bath, mature fruit trees	Standard floor plan, single oven, attached garage
HOA	None	Varies; many Moraga communities carry \$150–\$400/mo

The verdict: At \$885/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$750-\$820/sqft, this home sits near the upper end of that range. At \$885 per square foot, this home is priced above the top of the Moraga premium tier, which tops out near \$820 per square foot for well-updated homes. The lot size, finished garage, updated kitchen, and no-HOA status are all legitimate supports for a premium, but the gap between the asking price and the top of the market benchmark means the marketing had to work harder than a standard listing to close the distance. That case was never fully made, and that's the gap a relaunch needs to close.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Build the Visual Case for the Lot Before Buyers Arrive

The backyard, the fruit trees, the brick patio, and the cul-de-sac position are the kind of assets that move buyers at this price point - but only if they can see them clearly before they schedule a showing. Standard ground photography doesn't capture a 10,450-square-foot lot in context. A Sky Tour shows buyers exactly what they're getting: the setting, the privacy, and the scale that separates this home from comparable inventory. Buyers who understand the outdoor space before they visit are more motivated and more prepared to make a confident offer.

Pillar II - Tell a Premium Story That Justifies \$885 per Square Foot

Every detail in this home - the double ovens, the stone counters, the finished garage, the main-level guest suite, the built-in storage - adds up to a premium that is real and defensible. The marketing needs to present those details as a coherent argument, not a checklist. BrightWork writes listing remarks and structures portal placement the way a great buyer's agent explains a home: with logic and specificity, so the buyer can answer their own 'why this one' question before they ever talk to their agent. That's what turns a showing into an offer at the right number.

Pillar III - Find the Right Buyer Actively, Not Passively

The buyer for 206 Sheila Ct is likely a Bay Area family who has been researching Lamorinda schools and trail access for months and is ready to move when they find the right home. That buyer isn't waiting for a listing alert - they're being researched on Google and Instagram right now. BrightWork's geo-targeted campaigns are built to reach that buyer where they already are, in Moraga-specific context, before they've committed to another property. The goal isn't more clicks. It's the right buyer, found early, arriving at the door already sold on the neighborhood.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

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Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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